

**Web watch**

Google, Facebook and your other usual suspects change the web landscape one feature at a time

**App watch**

App updates and 10 fun apps that you haven't heard of. These apps will entertain you for hours

# Blackberry dominated, but other stuff happened in the mobile space too

Perhaps the most dynamic area of technology, mobile phones witness new developments almost every day

Since we last met, a lot has happened in the mobile segment. RIM made its series of announcements, rebranding itself, revealing new devices, a new OS, and upgrade paths. HTC finally unveiled its next generation flagship, the M7, calling it the HTC One. In the meanwhile, the previous generation flagship, the HTC Butterfly, was launched in India. Apple became the second largest mobile manufacturer in India, in terms of revenue and Samsung launched its new budget series, called Rex, taking on Nokia's Asha series in India. Qualcomm also officially unveiled the Snapdragon 200 and 400 series processors.

However, the biggest news stories in the mobile segment in the month of February probably broke during Mobile World Congress 2013 in Barcelona. Unfortunately, at the time of writing, MWC was still four days away, and in the interest of getting the magazine on stands in time for our eager readers, there was no option but to forego those juicy nuggets. You can catch up the latest though, by visiting [www.thinkdigit.com/latest/MWC\\_2013.html](http://www.thinkdigit.com/latest/MWC_2013.html)

## BB10 is here

At RIM's January 30th event, CEO Thorsten Heins announced that Research In Motion will be rebranded completely to BlackBerry. "From this point onwards, RIM becomes Black-



**BlackBerry Z10**

Berry. This is our promise of one brand," he said. "Our employees already work for BlackBerry, so from this day on we'll be known as BlackBerry."

As expected, there were two BB10 smartphones that were showcased. The first was the Z10, which is a full touch BB10 device. The second was the Q10. With this phone, BlackBerry stayed loyal to its majority demographic of users by offering the physical QWERTY keypad along with a touchscreen.

The popular BlackBerry Messenger now has Video Chat and voice calling, as well as the screen sharing features. The much awaited profile feature, BlackBerry Balance, can let you use the same device as two separate devices - one with a profile for work and one with a profile for home. Existing BlackBerry PlayBook owners would

be delighted to know that they have not been forgotten. On stage, CEO Heins announced that all PlayBook tablets will get the BlackBerry 10 upgrade.

## New Snapdragon 200 and 400 SOC's announced

The Snapdragon 400 has dual Krait CPUs going as high as 1.7GHz and quad ARM Cortex A-7 CPUs topping out at 1.4GHz with an Adreno 305 GPU. The processors feature the Asynchronous Symmetric Multiprocessing (aSMP), which helps keep it power efficient under full load. There is support for TDSCDMA, DC-HSPA+ (42Mbps), 1x Advanced, W+G CDMA, and multi-SIM capabilities of Dual SIM, Dual Standby (DSDS) and Dual SIM, Dual Active (DSDA) setups and also a camera up to 13.5MP.

Snapdragon 400 processors will come with the following numbering: 8226, 8626, 8230, 8630, 8930, 8030AB, 8230AB, 8630AB and 8930AB.

The lower end Snapdragon 200 brings you quad ARM Cortex-A5 CPUs going as high as 1.4GHz per core. The Adreno 203 GPU handles the graphics. It enables "high-accuracy" GPS and can handle HD video playback and supports dual SIM setups and offers camera support of up to 8MP. The Snapdragon 200 will be available in the following part numbers: 8225Q, 8625Q. No details on the pricing as yet.

## HTC One officially unveiled

The HTC One, known till now as the M7, has been officially unveiled by HTC. The One is powered by the quad-core Krait 300 processor clocking in at 1.7GHz on the Qualcomm Snapdragon 600 chipset, with Adreno 320 graphics and 2GB of RAM to help it along. The One has a 4.7-inch Super LCD 3 display, the same type as seen on the HTC Butterfly, with the Full HD resolution at 469ppi. A lot has been said about the Ultrapixel camera. On the spec sheet - the



**The HTC One**

camera has a 4MP sensor and can do 1080p@30fps video recording with HDR. The sensor allows 300 per cent more light in, allowing for even better shots in low light conditions. The camera also features gyroscope-based Optical image stabilization, for more stable videos, particularly ones shot on the move. 